House prices against incomes in Malta

The Commission's 2026 Country Report, checked against Eurostat

THE CLAIM

> ***"With income growth exceeding these gains, the price-to-income ratio has actually declined."***

European Commission, 2026 Country Report – Malta, 3 June 2026

After: nominal prices 'have risen steadily since 2014 and consistently outpace EU average growth'.

Annex 16 adds that the ratio 'has declined since 2007'; its source is Eurostat.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

True on the named indicator; not for median income since 2014.

SUPPORTED | **LARGELY SUPPORTED** | NOT SUBSTANTIATED | MISLEADING | CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

−11.5%

Ratio, 2014–2024

Eurostat's price-to-income ratio for Malta; −23.1% since 2007. EU-27: +5.8% since 2014.

+83.6%

Prices, 2014–2025

Up every year, by 3.4% to 6.7%. EU-27: +65.6%.

2020–22

EU faster

EU-27 prices rose faster than Malta's in three years, so 'consistently' is too strong.

+95.7%

Income per head

Household disposable income per head, national accounts, 2014–2024: faster than prices (+73.3%).

+62.6%

Median income

EU-SILC median household income grew slower than prices: on it the ratio rose 6.6%.

FAIR TO SAY

The ratio is an average of prices against income. It does not show affordability for renters or lower-income households.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

- ☐ Commission: the vintage behind its Graph A16.3.
- ☐ NSO: why national-accounts and survey income diverge.
- ☐ Central Bank: any household-level affordability series.
- ☐ No right of reply needed.